Obstructions and a Corrected Spectral Criterion for GRH

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Research draft. GRH is not proved here.

Abstract

We audit proposed surface-order and Hilbert–Pólya arguments for GRH. We prove obstructions to the proposed prime/geodesic identification, integral cyclic induction, absolute prime-tail estimates and determinant preservation, and retain a conditional spectral closure criterion. We construct convergent arithmetic approximants with explicit errors and analyze coefficient-defined Jensen metrics. From the explicit scalar local factors of a separate exponent argument, we extend an Euler-correction region and its principal-residue interface, and isolate a shifted infinite-order angular Hecke factor. Under the stated classical analytic inputs, its zeros obstruct extending the unchanged correction's nonvanishing criterion below 7/12. We also reconstruct a frozen-capacity row count conditionally on the source moment and witness estimates, and extend the low interface under explicit reflected-energy and Gram hypotheses. A pinned Lean 4 companion verifies selected arithmetic, complex-analytic, matrix and infinite-product components, with its remaining dependencies specified. These results do not establish GRH; the full arithmetic spectral bridge and the required mean-square and contour estimates remain unresolved.

1 Scope and conventions

For a primitive Dirichlet character χ of conductor q, write

$$L(s,\chi)=\sum_{n\geq 1}\frac{\chi(n)}{n^s},\qquad \Lambda(s,\chi)=\left(\frac{q}{\pi}\right)^{(s+a)/2}\Gamma\left(\frac{s+a}{2}\right)L(s,\chi),\quad a=\frac{1-\chi(-1)}{2}.$$

The series and Euler product initially apply for $\operatorname{Re} s>1$. Our target is Dirichlet GRH: every zero in $0<\operatorname{Re} s<1$ has real part $1/2$. For $q=1$, use the entire function $\xi(s)=\frac{1}{2}s(s-1)\Lambda(s,1)$ when an entire target is required. Finite-order Hecke characters and general Artin representations require separate constructions; a theorem for one family is not silently a theorem for another.

The supplied surface-order manuscripts [1, 2] propose arithmetic transfer operators and self-adjoint approximants. We isolate valid closure logic and prove obstructions to particular claimed constructions. These obstructions refute intermediate statements, not GRH. The separate `math` repository [3] includes claimed zero-free regions strictly weaker than GRH. Such a region cannot replace the missing critical-line argument.

2 A corrected conditional closure theorem

Theorem 2.1 (Spectral approximation criterion)**.** *Let $U\subset\mathbb{C}$ be connected and open, let f be holomorphic on U and not identically zero, and let*

$$F_N(s)=e^{a_N+b_N s}\det\bigl(sI-(\tfrac{1}{2}I+iH_N)\bigr),\qquad H_N=H_N^*\in M_{d_N}(\mathbb{C}).$$

If $F_N \to f$ locally uniformly on U, then every zero of f in U has real part $1/2$.

Proof. The eigenvalues $\lambda_{j,N}$ of H_N are real. Thus the zeros of F_N are $1/2 + i\lambda_{j,N}$, with algebraic multiplicities; the exponential factor never vanishes. If $f(z) = 0$ off that line, choose a closed disk $D \subset U$ about z disjoint from the line, with f nonzero on its boundary. Such a disk exists because the zeros of a nonzero holomorphic function on a connected domain are isolated. Let $m = \min_{\partial D} |f| > 0$. Local uniform convergence gives $|F_N - f| < m$ on ∂D for sufficiently large N. Rouché's theorem forces F_N and f to have the same positive number of zeros inside D, contradicting the zero location of F_N. □

Remark 2.2. This is a conditional criterion, not a construction. Self-adjointness alone establishes only the zero location of the approximants. The difficult arithmetic statement is convergence to the particular completed L-function. Pointwise convergence, weak operator convergence, and agreement of finitely many zeros do not supply the displayed hypothesis.

Proposition 2.3 (A usable continuation interface)**.** *Suppose U is a connected domain, the entire functions F_N are locally uniformly bounded on U, and they converge pointwise on a nonempty open subset $V \subset U$ to a holomorphic function f defined on U. Then $F_N \to f$ locally uniformly on U.*

Proof. Montel's theorem makes the family normal. Every subsequence has a further subsequence converging locally uniformly to a holomorphic function g. On V, pointwise convergence gives $g = f$, so the identity theorem gives $g = f$ on U. If the original sequence failed to converge locally uniformly, a compact set, positive error, and violating subsequence would contradict this subsequence property. □

A proposed analytic continuation proof must actually provide the uniform bounds and a genuine overlap V. The disjoint domains $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$ and $0 < \operatorname{Re} s < 1$ are not an overlap.

3 Arithmetic obstructions to the claimed completion

Theorem 3.1 (No integral prime-power geodesic norms)**.** *Let $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ be hyperbolic. Its expanding eigenvalue in absolute value is $u > 1$, and its hyperbolic norm is $N(\gamma) = u^2$. Then $N(\gamma)$ is not an integer greater than one. In particular no closed geodesic arising from such a matrix has length $k \log p$ for a prime p and integer $k \geq 1$.*

Proof. Put $t = |\operatorname{tr} \gamma| \in \mathbb{Z}$, so $t = u + u^{-1}$. If $u^2 = n \in \mathbb{Z}$, $n > 1$, squaring gives

$$t^2 = n + 2 + \frac{1}{n}.$$

The left-hand side and $n + 2$ are integers, so $1/n$ is an integer, contradicting $0 < 1/n < 1$. Since length is $\log N(\gamma)$, length $k \log p$ would imply $N(\gamma) = p^k$, already excluded. □

The statement applies to every subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, hence to congruence surfaces. The prime geodesic theorem is an asymptotic counting analogy; it cannot provide the termwise identification claimed in the completion section of [1]. Hecke correspondences of determinant p must not be identified with hyperbolic deck transformations of determinant one.

Theorem 3.2 (Failure of integral cyclic induction)**.** *The trivial character of $G = C_2 \times C_2$ is not an integer linear combination of characters induced from one-dimensional characters of cyclic subgroups of G.*

Proof. Every cyclic subgroup has order one or two. The degree of any such induced character is its index, namely four or two. Evaluation at the identity sends every integer linear combination to an even integer, whereas the trivial character has degree one. □

This distinguishes rational Artin induction from integral Brauer induction. It invalidates the stated cyclic integral reduction, while leaving appropriate forms of these classical induction theorems available for a revised argument.

Theorem 3.3 (Prime-tail obstruction)**.** *For every real $\sigma \le 1$, the positive series $\sum_p p^{-\sigma}$ diverges. Thus $\sum_{p>N} p^{-\sigma}$ is not a vanishing absolutely convergent tail in the critical strip.*

Proof. It suffices to show $\sum_p 1/p = \infty$, since $p^{-\sigma} \ge p^{-1}$. Suppose the reciprocal-prime series converged. For $0 \le x \le 1/2$, $-\log(1-x) \le 2x$, for example by integrating $(1-t)^{-1} \le 2$ from zero to x. Hence the finite Euler products $\prod_{p \le X}(1-1/p)^{-1}$ would be bounded uniformly in X. Expanding each as a finite product of absolutely convergent geometric series gives the sum of $1/n$ over all positive integers with prime factors at most X. In particular it dominates $\sum_{n \le \lfloor X \rfloor} 1/n$, which is unbounded. Contradiction. □

Any repair below $\operatorname{Re} s = 1$ must introduce proved cancellation or a regularization, with quantitative control; absolute prime-tail bounds cannot suffice.

4 Determinants and lost arithmetic information

For $T = \operatorname{diag}(\chi(p)p^{-s})_{p \le N}$ one has exactly

$$\det(I - T) = \prod_{p \le N} (1 - \chi(p)p^{-s}) = L_N(s, \chi)^{-1},$$

not L_N. On an absolute-convergence region,

$$\log\det(I - T) = -\sum_{k \ge 1} \frac{\operatorname{tr}(T^k)}{k}.$$

The reciprocal orientation matters before any analytic continuation. Moreover Hermitian-part extraction does not preserve this determinant:

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \frac{T + T^*}{2} = 0, \quad \det(I - T) = 2 \ne 1 = \det(I).$$

An identity for the transfer determinant therefore does not automatically identify the centered characteristic polynomial of a symmetrized operator.

Proposition 4.1 (A direct obstruction to the supplied diagonal diagnostic)**.** *For the $q = 1$ model evaluated at $s = 1/2$, the algorithm that sets $\lambda_p = -\arg(p^{-1/2})$ gives $H_N = 0$ and $F_N(s) = (s - 1/2)^{d_N}$. These functions cannot converge locally uniformly to $\Lambda(s, 1)$ or $\xi(s)$ on a neighborhood of $1/2$.*

Proof. Every $p^{-1/2}$ is positive, so its argument is zero and $F_N(1/2) = 0$. On the other hand the alternating Dirichlet series $\eta(1/2) = \sum_{n \ge 1}(-1)^{n-1}n^{-1/2}$ is positive: grouping into adjacent pairs gives positive terms and its sum is at least $1 - 1/\sqrt{2} > 0$. The continuation identity $\eta(s) = (1 - 2^{1-s})\zeta(s)$ gives $\zeta(1/2) < 0$. The gamma factor at $1/4$ is positive and finite, so $\Lambda(1/2, 1) \ne 0$, and its pole-removal factor at $1/2$ is nonzero. Even pointwise convergence at that point is impossible. □

Proposition 4.2 (Holomorphic Hermitian rigidity)**.** *Let $U \subset \mathbb{C}$ be connected and open, with a fixed inner product on $\mathbb{C}^d$. If $H : U \to M_d(\mathbb{C})$ has holomorphic entries and $H(s)^* = H(s)$ for every complex $s \in U$, then H is constant.*

Proof. In fixed orthonormal coordinates, for each vector v, the holomorphic scalar $v^*H(s)v$ is real-valued, so it is constant by the open mapping theorem. Polarization recovers all matrix entries from these quadratic forms, hence every entry is constant. Equivalently, $H_{ij} + H_{ji}$ and $i(H_{ij} - H_{ji})$ are real-valued holomorphic functions whose constancy determines H_{ij}. □

Thus a nonconstant arithmetic transfer $T(s)$ cannot retain entrywise holomorphy after pointwise Hermitian-part extraction: a holomorphic $(T + T^*)/2$ would be constant, and the remaining holomorphic skew-Hermitian part would be constant as well. This excludes that particular shortcut, not fixed self-adjoint operators. The spectral criterion uses H_N independent of the spectral variable s. Requiring self-adjointness only on a real parameter line is also consistent with a nonconstant holomorphic extension, but needs its own zero-location theorem.

Proposition 4.3 (A positive generalized spectral pencil)**.** *Let $A = A^*$ and $B = B^* > 0$ be fixed $d \times d$ matrices. Every zero of $\det(A - zB)$ is real. Consequently every zero of $\det(A + i(s - 1/2)B)$ lies on $\operatorname{Re} s = 1/2$.*

Proof. Singularity supplies $v \neq 0$ with $Av = zBv$. Hence $z = (v^*Av)/(v^*Bv)$, with real numerator and strictly positive real denominator. Thus z is real. Substitute $z = -i(s - 1/2)$. □

This supplies a valid finite spectral mechanism, but not its arithmetic construction. To apply it one must construct A_N, B_N, certify $B_N > 0$, and prove the required completed-L determinant approximation independently. Hermitian coefficients alone are insufficient: for

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \varepsilon \\ \varepsilon & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det(A - zB) = -(z^2 + \varepsilon^2),$$

$0 < \varepsilon < 1/2$ gives transported off-line zeros $s = 1/2 \pm \varepsilon$ inside the critical strip.

5 A necessary change of approximation class

Theorem 5.1 (Zero-free Euler truncations cannot approximate a zero)**.** *Let U be a connected open subset of $\{\operatorname{Re} s > 0\}$, let g_N be holomorphic and nowhere zero on U, and let P_N be arbitrary finite sets of rational primes. Put*

$$D_N(s) = \prod_{p \in P_N} (1 - \chi(p)e^{-s \log p}).$$

Each of $g_N D_N$ and g_N / D_N is holomorphic and nowhere zero on U. If either sequence converges locally uniformly to a holomorphic f which is not identically zero, then f has no zero in U.

Proof. For $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$, $|\chi(p)e^{-s \log p}| \leq p^{-\operatorname{Re} s} < 1$, so every local factor is nonzero. Hence the finite product, its reciprocal, and their normalized versions have the asserted property. If f had a zero, choose a closed disk inside U with a positive number of zeros of f in its interior and none on its boundary. Local uniform convergence and Rouché's theorem would force the zero-free approximants to have that positive number of zeros, a contradiction. □

More quantitatively, on any such disk D, every zero-free holomorphic approximant G satisfies

$$\max_{\partial D} |G - f| \;\geq\; \min_{\partial D} |f| > 0.$$

Otherwise Rouché yields the same contradiction. Thus improved estimates cannot repair this approximation class near a nontrivial zero. The construction must change so that finite approximants can have zeros in the strip; a nonvanishing gamma or exponential normalization cannot do this.

6 A convergent arithmetic replacement

For a nonprincipal character modulo q, put $A(x) = \sum_{n \leq x} \chi(n)$ and $B = \sup_x |A(x)| \leq q$. Complete periods sum to zero, so B is finite. Partial summation gives, for $\sigma = \operatorname{Re} s > 0$,

$$L(s,\chi) - \sum_{n \leq N} \chi(n) n^{-s} = -A(N)N^{-s} + s \int_N^\infty A(x) x^{-s-1}\, dx,$$

and therefore

$$\left| L(s,\chi) - \sum_{n \leq N} \chi(n) n^{-s} \right| \leq B \left(1 + \frac{|s|}{\sigma}\right) N^{-\sigma}.$$

The endpoint tends to zero and the integral is absolutely convergent. The limit agrees with the Euler definition on $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$, hence with its analytic continuation. Multiplication by the correct gamma/conductor factor gives locally uniform approximation on $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$ for either parity.

For zeta, reproduce the pole before removing it. Set

$$Z_N(s) = \sum_{n \leq N} n^{-s} + \frac{N^{1-s}}{s-1}.$$

Euler summation gives, for $\sigma > 0$ and $s \neq 1$,

$$\zeta(s) - Z_N(s) = -s \int_N^\infty \{x\} x^{-s-1}\, dx, \qquad |\zeta(s) - Z_N(s)| \leq \frac{|s|}{\sigma} N^{-\sigma}.$$

The integral continues holomorphically to $\sigma > 0$. Consequently

$$\xi_N(s) = \frac{s}{2} \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) \left((s-1) \sum_{n \leq N} n^{-s} + N^{1-s} \right)$$

is holomorphic on that half-plane, including $s = 1$, and converges locally uniformly to ξ; in fact $\xi_N(1) = 1/2$ for every N. These constructions use known arithmetic coefficients, not unknown zeros. They avoid Theorem 5.1 by allowing additive cancellation and unrestricted finite-level zeros. They establish convergence, but provide no self-adjoint realization or critical-line theorem for those zeros.

7 A certified test of the arithmetic pencil candidate

Let χ be the primitive nonprincipal character modulo 3. Its fifth Dirichlet partial sum is the entire function

$$f(s) = S_5(s,\chi) = 1 - 2^{-s} + 4^{-s} - 5^{-s}.$$

Theorem 7.1 (Certified zero of a finite partial sum)**.** *Put*

$$c = (337261 + 11027504i)/10^6, \qquad r = 10^{-4}.$$

The disk $|s - c| < r$ *contains exactly one zero of* f*, counted with multiplicity, and lies inside* $0 < \operatorname{Re} s < 1/2$*.*

Proof. The exact rational procedure detailed in the extended edition establishes

$$|f(c)| < 10^{-6}, \qquad |f'(c)| > 1, \qquad \sup_{|s-c|\le r} |f''(s)| \le 9.$$

It uses 60 terms of the logarithm's positive atanh series and terms 0 through 120 of the exponential Taylor series, with explicit remainders; no floating-point value is used in these inequalities. On the boundary, Taylor's formula gives

$$|f(s) - f'(c)(s-c)| < 10^{-6} + \tfrac{9}{2}r^2 < r < |f'(c)(s-c)|.$$

Rouché gives exactly one zero, which is therefore simple. The real part throughout the closed disk belongs to $[337161, 337361]/10^6 \subset (0, 1/2)$. □

The completed fifth partial sum has the same zero because its conductor/gamma factor is holomorphic and nonzero on this disk. It cannot equal a nowhere-zero holomorphic factor times the determinant of a fixed positive Hermitian pencil there. This rejects that exact finite-level identification. It does not reject convergence of the partial sums, modified approximants, later truncations, subsequences, or GRH itself: f is a finite partial sum, not the full L-function.

8 Jensen approximants and a coefficient-defined metric

This alternative currently concerns the Riemann target only. Define

$$\gamma_j = \frac{j!\,\xi^{(2j)}(1/2)}{(2j)!}, \qquad F(w) = \sum_{j\ge 0} \frac{\gamma_j}{j!} w^j, \qquad \Xi(t) = \xi(1/2 + it) = F(-t^2).$$

The classical positive Fourier kernel of Ξ gives $\gamma_j > 0$ [9]; evenness and entirety of ξ make F entire. Set, for $d \ge 1$,

$$J_d(x) = \sum_{j=0}^{d} \binom{d}{j} \gamma_j x^j, \qquad Q_d(w) = J_d(w/d), \qquad P_d(t) = Q_d(-t^2).$$

Proposition 8.1 (Explicit convergence without a zero-location premise)**.** *For* $R, T \ge 0$*,*

$$\sup_{|w|\le R} |Q_d(w) - F(w)| \le \frac{R^2 F''(R)}{2d}, \qquad \sup_{|t|\le T} |P_d(t) - \Xi(t)| \le \frac{T^4 F''(T^2)}{2d}.$$

Proof. The coefficient multiplier $w_{d,j} = j!\binom{d}{j}/d^j$ for $j \le d$, and 0 for $j > d$, satisfies $0 \le w_{d,j} \le 1$ and $1 - w_{d,j} \le j(j-1)/(2d)$. For $j \le d$ use $1 - \prod_{k<j}(1 - k/d) \le \sum_{k<j} k/d$; for $j > d$ use $j(j-1) \ge 2d$. Summing the absolutely convergent series with nonnegative coefficients proves the bounds. □

Let C_d be the multiplication-by-x companion of the monic J_d/γ_d, and $H_d = (m_{i+j})_{0\le i,j<d}$, where $m_k = \operatorname{tr}(C_d^k)$ and $m_0 = d$. Newton identities compute H_d from the coefficients, and $H_d C_d = C_d^T H_d$. The Hermite–Sylvester criterion gives $H_d \ge 0$ exactly when J_d is real-rooted [8]; then its positive coefficients force all roots negative. If $H_d > 0$, the extended edition constructs an explicit real symmetric K_d with

$$P_d(t) = \frac{(-1)^d \gamma_d}{d^d} \det(tI - K_d).$$

Strict positivity is needed for that construction; semidefinite metrics can be singular. The classical Jensen criterion makes $H_d \ge 0$ for every d equivalent to zeta RH [7]. This identifies the missing positivity; it does not prove it. Fixed-degree eventual hyperbolicity as the shift grows does not settle this unshifted growing-degree family.

Proposition 8.2 (Positive smooth kernels do not supply the metric)**.** *Positivity of an even smooth Fourier density, including Gaussian decay, does not imply positivity of its Jensen Newton-sum metric.*

Proof. Convolve $\frac{9}{10}\delta_0 + \frac{1}{20}(\delta_{-1} + \delta_1)$ with a centered Gaussian of variance $v > 0$. Its Fourier transform is $e^{-vt^2/2}(9/10 + \cos t/10)$ and its density is strictly positive, even and Schwartz. Writing its associated $F(w) = \sum \gamma_j w^j/j!$ gives $\gamma_0 = 1$, $\gamma_1 = (v + 1/10)/2$ and $\gamma_2 = (3v^2 + 3v/5 + 1/10)/12$. Thus $\gamma_1^2 - \gamma_0\gamma_2 = -7/1200 < 0$; the degree-two Newton-sum metric has negative determinant. These are model coefficients, not the arithmetic ξ coefficients. □

9 Extending an Euler correction and locating an additional factor

We now test one missing analytic input of the September argument in [3]. All deductions in this section use its displayed scalar local identity; its preceding Gauss/reciprocity derivation and main mean-square theorem are not certified here.

Proposition 9.1 (Extension of the explicit local product)**.** *The displayed correction product $\mathcal{H}_{\eta,u}(x, w, z)$ converges normally on a neighborhood of*

$$\operatorname{Re} x \ge 3/4, \qquad \operatorname{Re} w \ge 19/20, \qquad \operatorname{Re} z \ge 33/200,$$

and is $O_\epsilon(q_u^\epsilon)$ there. On the displayed closed region, for $Q = Np$, its local defects are at most $1024Q^{-149/100}$ when $p \nmid u$ and $32Q^{-7/10}$ when $p \mid u$. The latter is an upper bound, not a nonvanishing statement.

Proof. Substitution in the explicit local formulas gives the exponent and denominator bounds detailed in the extended edition. All five positive row valuations are included. The ideal count sums the first bound; the divisor-product estimate handles the finitely many primes of u. The bounds retain a positive margin on a larger open region. □

For the principal row put $H_\eta(s) = \mathcal{H}_{\eta,1}(s, 1, 1/6)$. At a prime set

$$v = Q^{-1}, \quad d = \eta(p)Q^{-s}, \quad \theta(p) = \alpha(p)^{-6}\eta(p)^6, \quad r = \theta(p)Q^{3-6s},$$

where $\alpha(p) = p/|p|$ for a generator. Sixth powers remove unit ambiguity. Exact simplification gives

$$H_p = \frac{(1 - v^2)[1 - vr - (1 - v)d]}{(1 - r)(1 - d)}, \qquad A_p = (1 - r)H_p.$$

For $\operatorname{Re} s > 1/2$, the numerator is nonzero because $|vr + (1-v)d| < v + (1-v) = 1$. Moreover

$$A_p - 1 = -v^2 + \frac{(1-v^2)v(d-r)}{1-d}.$$

Thus $A = \prod_{p \notin S} A_p$ is holomorphic and nonzero on $\operatorname{Re} s > 1/2$, while H_η itself converges normally and is nonzero on $\operatorname{Re} s > 2/3$. On the latter region the exact factorization is

$$H_\eta(s) = A(s) L_F^S(6s - 3, \theta).$$

The character θ has nontrivial angular factor α^{-6}; it has infinite order and is outside the source's finite-order target family. The correction can be made uniformly close to 1 on each fixed $\operatorname{Re} s \geq \sigma_0 > 2/3$ by a sufficiently large finite deletion. This supplies the proposed tiny perturbation's local Euler input; the compensated contour errors and mean squares remain unproved.

Proposition 9.2 (Limitation of the unchanged correction)**.** *Assume the scalar identity and the classical Hecke completion properties listed in the extended edition, including order one and conjugation. The analytic continuation of this unchanged H_η has a zero with real part at least $7/12$. It therefore cannot be nonzero throughout $\operatorname{Re} s > \sigma_0$ for any $\sigma_0 < 7/12$.*

Proof. The entire order-one completion of $L(s, \theta)$ has infinitely many zeros: otherwise Hadamard factorization would contradict its $\sigma \log \sigma + O(\sigma)$ logarithmic growth on the positive axis. Euler nonvanishing, the functional equation and conjugation give a zero ρ with $1/2 \leq \operatorname{Re} \rho \leq 1$. Neither gamma nor deleted Euler factors vanish there. Hence the displayed continuation vanishes at $(\rho+3)/6$, where A is nonzero and $\operatorname{Re} s \geq 7/12$. □

The Hecke analytic inputs are classical external dependencies, not Lean theorems here [10, 11]. No GRH or Artin holomorphy premise is used. This limits the specified probe and nonvanishing criterion; it does not refute GRH, the claimed 7/8 result, or different constructions.

10 The compensated principal residue at perturbed parameters

We retain the source's scalar local identity, exact high representation, Mellin integrated/trace tail contracts, and polynomial reciprocal control on $\operatorname{Re} s = \beta_* + e$. The following verifies a principal interface, not the remaining energy or row-count estimates. On the enlarged Euler region, the four local multiplier errors have powers

$$Q^{-x_r}, \quad Q^{-6z_r}, \quad Q^{4-5x_r-6z_r}, \quad Q^{1-w_r-6z_r}.$$

Their common saving is at least $37/50$. The local lower bound for H_p therefore gives $\mathcal{B}_p = -1 + O(Q^{-37/50})$, uniformly in all heights. On fixed real boxes the full principal correction is $O(Z^{\ell \operatorname{Re} z})$, with height degree zero.

For a nonempty fixed slot system with positive lengths ℓ_i, set

$$S_i = \sum_{p \in \mathcal{P}_i(Z)} W_i(Q/P_i) Q^{-5/6}, \qquad A_T = (-1)^K Z^{-\ell/6} \prod_i S_i, \qquad \mu = \tfrac{7}{10} \min_i \ell_i > 0.$$

Fixed-ray prime counting gives $S_i > 0$ eventually and $A_T \sim c_T (\log Z)^{-K}$ with $c_T \neq 0$, of sign $(-1)^K$ [12]. No uniformity in a moving ray conductor is used. Nonnegative weights give the exact residue factorization

$$\mathfrak{H}_{\eta,1,Z}(s, 1, 1/6) = H_\eta(s) Z^{\ell/6} A_T(Z)(1 + \mathcal{R}_{\eta,Z}(s)), \qquad \mathcal{R}_{\eta,Z} = O(Z^{-\mu}).$$

Indeed the ith relative error is the negative weighted average of $\mathcal{B}_p + 1$, of size $O(P_i^{-37/50})$; a fixed finite product preserves that saving. Also $|A_T|^{-1} \ll_\epsilon Z^\epsilon$.

With the explicitly inherited contracts above, the source's principal contour comparison now extends to $3/4 \le \sigma_0 < \beta_*$. Its three remainders, relative to $C(\beta_*)$, have exponents

$$(1+h)e - l_y/20 + \epsilon, \qquad e - h/600 + \epsilon, \qquad e - \mu + \epsilon.$$

The extended edition derives these by crossing only $w = 1$ and $z = 1/6$. All three are negative for sufficiently small pretarget e, ϵ. The perturbed geometry at $t = 10^{-5}$ satisfies this interface, with $C(s) = s - 11/16$ and target $349999/400000$. This is not a new zero-free theorem: other low and nonprincipal contour inputs remain unverified; the following counting interface is conditional on its moment inputs.

There is a separate pointwise limitation. At the principal residue, putting $N = 1 - vr - (1-v)d$ gives

$$\mathcal{B}_p + 1 = \frac{(1-v)[r/d - vr - (1-v)d]}{N}.$$

For fixed $1/2 < \sigma = \operatorname{Re} s \le 3/5$ its norm is asymptotic to $Q^{3-5\sigma}$, uniformly in phases. In particular, for $\eta = 1$ and an inert rational prime, $\alpha^{-6} = 1$ and real $s = 3/5$ give $r = d$, so $\mathcal{B}_p = -1/Q$ exactly. The error around -1 tends to 1. Such primes can occur in the fixed identity ray. This excludes the pointwise power-saving argument there, without excluding cancellation after prime averaging or a different normalization.

11 A frozen-capacity counting interface

The next proposition concerns the September probe, not the spectral construction. Its arithmetic moment and witness inputs remain uncertified. The previously claimed 7/8 bound is an explicit hypothesis here.

Proposition 11.1 (Conditional row count)**.** *Assume $\beta_* \le 7/8$ and the source's marked inverse moment, plain fourth moment, sixth-power amplification and simultaneous saturated witness statements, with their common profiles, masks and height bounds. For each $\epsilon > 0$, first choose capacity decrements and a slot-mesh threshold independent of the eventual fixed slot count. Then fix a finite slot system satisfying it and a retained nonfloor bin, $a > 51/100$, of sixth-power-free rows of norm $\asymp U = Z^d$, where $d \ge d_{\min} > 0$. Put $\delta = 2a - 1 \le 3/4$, $x = q/\delta \in [0, 1/2]$, where q is its length-weighted prime amplitude. Suppose the total available prime-slot length ℓ/d exceeds $7/37$ by a fixed margin. Then*

$$\#\mathcal{B} \ll U^{R_*+\epsilon}(1+T_1)^A, \quad R_* = 1 - \delta + \frac{(\alpha-\delta)\delta P}{2J}, \quad \alpha = 5/6,$$

where $D = 3 - 17x/9$, $P = (2 - 8x/9)(1-x)$ and $J = (\alpha-\delta)D + \delta P > 0$. The finite height order A is fixed before the external tail order. Without selected prime slots one instead has exponent $1 - 2\delta/3$, with no supply assumption.

Proof. The plain moment permits $\kappa = 3/4$ since $\beta_* \le (1+\kappa)/2$. Its exact zero-loss capacity is $z_P(m) = 2(1-2m)/9$; the inverse capacity is $z_M(r) = (1-r)/2$. Thus the source's $\Delta/4$ comparison loss is absent, rather than continued to a negative bootstrap parameter. At detector cutoff $\tau \in [1, 3/2]$, the saturated witnesses have $r + m \ge \tau - o(1)$, $|M_r|^2 \gg U^{\delta r - \epsilon}$ and $|S_m|^2 \gg U^{\delta m - \epsilon}$. Selecting whole positive slots of requested length z gives squared gain $U^{2qz - \epsilon_{\text{round}}}$, with the fixed

rounding loss $\epsilon_{\mathrm{round}}$ allocated within ϵ. Division of the moments by these spikes, using $|S_m|^4$ for the plain moment, gives the affine short counts

$$A_I(r) = 1 - \delta[x + (1-x)r], \quad S_\tau(r) = 1 - \delta[4x/9 + (2 - 8x/9)(\tau - r)].$$

They cross at $r_* = [(2 - 8x/9)\tau - 5x/9]/D$, with $23/37 \le r_* \le 1$ and $1/3 \le \tau - r_* \le 1/2$. Choose the plain count below r_* and the inverse count above it. Their common upper bound is $R_{\mathrm{short}}(\tau) = 1 - \delta + (\delta P/D)(3/2 - \tau)$. The requested inverse length is at most $7/37$, and the plain length at most $2/27 + o(1)$. A fixed capacity decrement preserves the strict marked-moment margins. Near zero capacity use the no-slot moments. For $r \ge 1$, amplification gives $L(\tau) = 1 - \delta + (\alpha - \delta)(\tau - 1)$. The maximum of these short and long bounds is minimized at $\tau = 1 + \delta P/(2J)$, giving R_*. With no selection, use $\tau = 1$; the short lines cross at $r = 2/3$, giving $1 - 2\delta/3$. All rounding and witness losses fit the prescribed ϵ. □

For $\ell_t = 1/6 + t$, $h_t = 13/16 + 3t/2$, the supply holds uniformly through $d \le h_t + \zeta$ whenever

$$0 \le \zeta < \frac{37\ell_t}{7} - h_t = \frac{23}{336} + \frac{53t}{14}.$$

This closes the frozen-capacity counting interface at $t = 10^{-5}$ under its explicit inputs. It does not certify those arithmetic moments, the earlier 7/8 theorem, the low reflected-energy application or the remaining nonprincipal contours. Floor-bin rows need separate estimates.

12 The perturbed low estimate

Proposition 12.1 (Conditional low interface)**.** *Assume the source's general reflected-energy estimate, completed-row and sector identities, quantitative Gram bound and exact finite low separation, with their stated coefficient, support, smoothness and height uniformities. For* $0 \le t \le 1/30$*, put*

$$\ell_t = 1/6 + t, \quad M_t = 5/6 - t, \quad l_x = 17/48 - t/2, \quad l_y = 23/48 - t/2.$$

For every fixed finite system of disjoint physical prime slots with positive lengths of total ℓ_t *and the original admissible smooth weights, the same finite compensated probe satisfies*

$$|I_{\eta,\mathrm{modified},t}(Z)| \ll Z^{3/16 - t/4 + \epsilon} \qquad (\epsilon > 0).$$

The constant and threshold may depend on that slot system; the exponent has no mesh loss. No prior zero-free theorem is needed for this implication.

Proof. For a rescaled subset of length d, put $M' = M_t - 2d$ and $\ell' = \ell_t - d$. The retained dual-range calculation keeps $M' + \ell' - 1 = -3d$. The general energy formula gives

$$\sum_{0 < q_m \ll Q} |B_m^J|^2 \ll Z^{M' + s_t(d) + \epsilon}, \qquad s_t(d) = \left(\frac{-1/6 + 5t + d}{4}\right)_+.$$

The extended edition verifies the support mapping and a uniform exponent bound including finite logarithmic offsets; the general arithmetic energy estimate remains a hypothesis. The tuple ratio $r_J = q_{p_J}/Z^d$ stays in a fixed compact subset of $(0, \infty)$, and

$$X' = Z^{l_x - d}/r_J, \quad Y' = Z^{l_y - d}/r_J, \quad Q = q_{b_*} X'Y', \quad P_a = Y'^2/Q = q_{b_*}^{-1} Z^{1/8}.$$

Uniformly over subsets, $l_x - d \geq 11/80$, $l_y - d \geq 21/80$, $M' \geq 2/5$ and $l_y - d - 11/48 \geq 1/30$. Thus $Q, Y', P_a \geq 1$ eventually and $P_a^2/Y' \ll P_a^{1/6}$. The assumed Gram bound and Cauchy–Schwarz give the unscaled tuple bound $(X')^{1/2} P_a^{1/12} Z^{s_t(d)/2+\epsilon}$, with a fixed polynomial height cost integrated against the external smooth Mellin transform. The number of tuples, their coefficient and $X'^{1/2}$ contribute $d - 3d/2 - d/2 = -d$. Since $t \leq 1/30$ and $d \geq 0$,

$$s_t(d) \leq d/4, \qquad -d + s_t(d)/2 \leq -7d/8 \leq 0.$$

Sum the finitely many subsets after allocating the small losses. The final exponent is $l_x/2 + (1/8)/12 = 3/16 - t/4$. □

The potential row loss must be retained in this proof, rather than set to zero for every subset. The real-power absorption and reflected exponent inequalities are kernel-checked components; the arithmetic energy and Gram bounds are not. This closes the conditional low interface at $t = 10^{-5}$, leaving the nonprincipal contours and the deep source inputs unverified. It gives no unconditional new zero-free theorem.

13 Consequences for a revised research article

Theorems 3.1, 3.2, and 3.3 require replacements for the associated proof steps, not additional exposition. A credible next theorem would construct operators independently of unknown zeros and establish their exact arithmetic determinant, including ramified, archimedean, and conductor terms. It must then prove locally uniform convergence or the local boundedness in Proposition 2.3. Only then does Theorem 2.1 prove the desired zero location.

Weil/Li positivity, adelic trace methods, and canonical-product approximations are potential alternative interfaces. They move the research obligation to a specific positivity, trace, or approximation theorem; they do not discharge it by analogy. Lagarias [4] and Connes [5] provide relevant primary-source starting points. No novelty or complete proof is claimed for these classical conditional principles.

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